

Fishing

Rain or shine, anglers spend hours waiting for a fish to take their bait. Some eat their catch, but many throw the fish back. So what is the big attraction? Anglers enjoy the peace and quiet, pitting their wits against the fish, and having their skill rewarded.

WHERE TO FISH

There are three main types of fishing: freshwater fishing (sometimes called coarse fishing), saltwater fishing, and fly-fishing. In freshwater and saltwater fishing, anglers use baits and lures to attract fish. In fly-fishing, they use imitation flies instead. Freshwater environments include ponds, lakes, streams, and rivers. Fly-fishing can happen in fresh or salt water.



STILL WATER

Ponds and lakes are home to carp, pike, and other freshwater species. Anglers fish from the bank or a boat.



RUNNING WATER

Streams and rivers are the place to catch salmon, trout, bream, and perch. Anglers fish from the bank or wade in.



SALT WATER

Most saltwater fishing is from boats close to shore or out at sea. Anglers also sit on sea walls, or wade in the shallows.

RODS, REELS, AND LINES

A simple stick or length of bamboo can work as a rod, with a line and hook tied on – but most anglers have high-tech rods made of fibreglass or carbon fibre. They come apart for easy carrying and are used with a reel to wind in and stow the line. Multiplier reels allow faster winding than fixed spools, as each turn of the handle spins the drum several times. Super-fast fly reels are used for fly-fishing.



MULTIPLIER REEL



FIXED-SPOOL REEL



FLY REEL



FISHING LINES



FLOAT ROD (IN FOUR PIECES)

FISHING TACKLE

A tackle box with a handle is essential for transporting equipment and keeping it all organized. The best designs open out so that the compartments are tiered.



BAIT

Even everyday scraps of bread will attract fish, but there are better baits to use. Live types include worms and maggots. Sweetcorn, seeds, grains, and dog biscuits work well, too. "Boilies" are processed bait balls, high in protein, that come in many colours and flavours.



RED BOILIES



YELLOW BOILIES



DOG BISCUITS



SWEETCORN



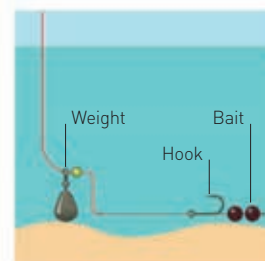
WORMS



WAX WORMS

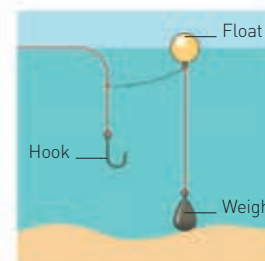
WEIGHTS

Weights help bring the end of the line close to the fish. Anglers use them to anchor the bait on the bottom or keep it at a particular depth. Most weights are made of a soft metal called lead. Different shapes do different jobs. The smallest – split shot – slots, or crimps, on to the line under a float to position it in the flow of water. The combination of the line, hook, bait, and weight is called a rig.



HAIR RIG FOR CARP

Carp are wary fish. The bait is attached to the hook on a fine, weighted line. The fish sucks up the bait without feeling the hook.



CATFISH RIG

Catfish can be huge. Live bait is fixed to the hook. The baited rig is tied to a float that is secured by a weight on the riverbed.



LEAD WEIGHTS



SPLIT SHOT



WIRE